

The Sunlit Wanderer Portrait Site

Initial Requirements Brief for Claude

Requirements Status — V1 Launch Baseline

This document defines the approved baseline requirements for the initial portrait-site build.

Items explicitly identified as future, optional, placeholder, unresolved, or requiring approval are **not blockers to beginning development** and should not be treated as permission to invent a final decision.

If a new idea arises after development begins, first determine whether it:

- corrects a requirement,
- is necessary for launch,
- or is an enhancement that belongs in the future backlog.

Do not expand launch scope solely because an additional feature would be possible or useful.

When requirements conflict, stop and identify the conflict rather than choosing one interpretation without approval.

Locked requirements: these should not move casually.

- launch services
- pricing amounts
- image minimums
- ShootProof stays the transaction/gallery system
- client privacy/model-release philosophy
- 30-day gallery period
- 7–10 business-day delivery
- mobile-first/simple UX
- core pages
- Locations page
- no analytics at launch
- preview before publish
- version control/change control

Those are requirements.

Approved structure, flexible execution: Claude can propose how best to implement these.

- exact page layouts

- whether Locations sits inside a Sessions dropdown
- exact gallery component
- exact technical framework
- exact hosting platform
- precise mobile breakpoints
- optimization method

Those are design/technical decisions, not business requirements.

Open decisions that Claude must not guess:

- final Brief/Standard/Extended names
- final logo/wordmark
- missing Pinterest links
- final location descriptions
- exact portfolio photographs
- category-specific multiple-subject rules such as twin seniors

Your document already handles that last one properly by specifically telling Claude not to invent universal per-person/per-session rules.

Backlog/future scope:

- Pets
- Lifestyle Newborn
- Boudoir
- Santa/Holiday
- private woods
- Local Favorites
- Albums & Keepsakes
- Prop Library expansions
- location videos as you create them

1. Project purpose

Build a **mobile-first portrait photography information website** for **The Sunlit Wanderer**.

The primary domain is already used by Shopify. This portrait site should therefore be designed to eventually live on a subdomain such as:

portraits.thesunlitwanderer.com

Use my own voice throughout the site and maintain a professional, personal, friendly and informative vibe.

The site is **not** intended to replace ShootProof.

ShootProof remains responsible for:

- bookings
- questionnaires
- contracts
- invoices/payments
- private client galleries
- downloads
- print releases
- other client-specific transactional functions

The new site serves three primary purposes:

1. Help prospective clients quickly evaluate the photography, pricing and experience.
2. Make it extremely easy to book through ShootProof after finding all relevant info/FAQs.
3. Replace long PDF preparation guides with an intuitive mobile resource clients can revisit before and after booking with simplicity and their ease of use important to keep in mind when designing.

Prioritize **simplicity, clarity, photography and ease of navigation** over decorative complexity.

2. Primary client questions

Design the experience around what a prospective client is most likely asking:

1. Do I like their portfolio gallery?
2. Can I afford the pricing?
3. Does this experience sound comfortable/easy?
4. Does the provided service meet my needs?
5. Where are some potential locations in this area for a session?
6. How do I see availability and book?

Deeper preparation information should never obstruct those first decisions.

3. Launch services

Public launch categories:

- Families & Kids
- High-School Seniors
- Maternity
- Couples & Engagement

Explicitly **do not advertise** at launch:

- weddings
- event coverage
- pets
- newborn photography
- boudoir
- private woodland location
- holiday/Santa sessions

Wedding photography should be clearly stated as **not offered**, particularly on the Couples & Engagement page.

Pets, lifestyle-specific newborn photography, boudoir and other categories may be added later.

4. Geographic positioning

Primary public wording:

Dayton, Ohio and surrounding communities

Typical service radius:

approximately 30 miles from Dayton, Ohio

Longer-distance sessions may be considered individually and could involve an additional travel fee.

SEO/service-area copy may naturally reference genuine service communities including relevant Dayton-area and nearby Ohio/Indiana communities, but:

- do not keyword-stuff
 - do not dump city names unnaturally into headers/meta descriptions
 - prioritize useful human-readable copy
-

5. Photography style and positioning

The photographer's approach is:

- relaxed
- friendly

- patient
- guided but not rigidly posed
- interaction-driven
- outdoors-focused
- candid mixed with intentional direction
- adaptable to personalities and age groups

Family photography should emphasize **relationships and genuine interaction rather than achieving a technically perfect traditional pose.**

- Examples of direction may include:
- walking together
- holding hands
- children whispering something funny to a parent
- siblings interacting
- lying together on a blanket
- children climbing on or hugging parents
- shoulder rides
- movement
- playful prompts
- natural family interaction

The photographer does **not physically manipulate clients into poses.** No physical touching is ever necessary but vocal coaching and guidance is common.

For seniors and couples, posing is more collaborative and intentional. Inspiration examples may be shown, clients may mimic ideas they like, and the photographer provides verbal guidance and reassurance.

The website should clearly communicate this philosophy so clients seeking rigid/formal posing can recognize that this may not be the right photography style for them.

6. Session pricing

Display pricing publicly.

Brief Session — \$150

Approximately **15 minutes**

Expect:

10+ professionally edited final images

Best for clients wanting a focused update rather than extensive variety.

Examples:

- one strong updated family portrait
- several photographs of the children
- a short maternity collection
- a senior wanting only the essentials
- one focused purpose

Standard Session — \$275

Approximately **40 minutes**

Expect:

30+ professionally edited final images

Best for most clients seeking greater variety, movement around a location, different backgrounds and/or family combinations.

Useful for:

- frames
- gifts
- small albums
- several family groupings

Extended Session — \$425

Approximately **90 minutes**

Expect:

50+ professionally edited final images

Best for:

- fuller photographic storytelling
- multiple looks
- outfit changes
- more family combinations
- multiple nearby locations
- larger albums
- gallery walls
- more comprehensive senior sessions

Universal image policy

Every session includes: **all professionally edited photographs selected for the final gallery.**

Clients do not select a small number of files and do not pay extra to unlock additional final photographs.

Minimum image counts establish expectations; actual galleries may contain more when additional strong photographs are produced but this is a natural enjoyable surprise for clients and not communicated. Only the minimum expectation outlined is to be communicated publicly.

Internet usage

Portraits in gallery will not be shared publicly online on website, social media, or any other form of marketing unless explicit permission is granted through the signing of model release.

7. Homepage architecture

Prioritize mobile.

Recommended order:

Hero Image

One excellent portrait photograph rather than an automatic slideshow.

Include:

The Sunlit Wanderer

Relaxed portrait photography in Dayton, Ohio and surrounding areas.

Sessions from \$150

Primary actions:

- Portfolio Gallery
- See Availability & Book

Quiet secondary action:

- Questions? Message Me

Avoid autoplay/moving hero imagery.

Already Booked?

Prominent but non-salesy shortcut:

Already booked? Prepare for your session →

This bypasses portfolio/marketing content.

Mixed portfolio gallery

Approximately **12–20 strongest photographs** representing all public categories.

Gallery behavior:

- clean grid
- tap photograph to enlarge
- fullscreen/lightbox
- swipe between images on mobile

Plan Your Session

01 — Choose your coverage

02 — Choose your session

03 — Find your setting

Pricing

Three simple session cards.

Emphasize **what each session accomplishes**, not merely the minutes.

Which coverage fits what you need? explanation.

Come up with a better suggestion of on-brand zero cheesiness way of wording these three pricing tiers. Nothing like Bronze Silver or Gold. Throw out suggestions for approval. **Working labels only:** Brief / Standard / Extended. Before finalizing public copy, propose 5–8 concise, non-cheesy naming approaches that fit the brand. Do not use Bronze/Silver/Gold or luxury-style upsell terminology. I will approve the final names before they are published. If Brief, Standard, and Extended end up making the most sense, everything should be changed to reflect those names.

Brief (\$150) - great for a new family portrait + a touch more

15-minute session, 10+ high-resolution professionally edited digital images delivered in a private ShootProof gallery, optional gallery iPhone or Android app, with personal printing rights

Standard (\$275)- most popular session with poses and various ideas and time for more variety;

great for when you want the new family portrait plus enough new candids and mix of siblings and mom and dad only, funny, serious, etc.

40-minute session, 30+ high-resolution professionally edited digital images delivered in a private ShootProof gallery, optional gallery iPhone or Android app, with personal printing rights

Extended (\$425) - Perfect for families who haven't had their professional portraits taken together in years, seek to update their home decor and walls with new memories AND have enough variety of images for a memory photo album, nice for displaying on a coffee table and/or gifts for grandparents. This session offers time necessary for a variety of shooting siblings solo, together, with a variety and mix of scenic backgrounds and poses.

90-minute session, up to 2-3 locations when practical, 50+ high-resolution professionally edited digital images delivered in a private ShootProof gallery, optional gallery iPhone or Android app, with personal printing rights

Session pricing includes the photography session, professionally edited digital files, and personal printing and social-sharing rights. Travel fees may apply to approved locations outside the standard service area and will be discussed before booking.

Do not invent universal per-person/per-session language. Different session categories may require different rules for multiple primary subjects. Leave this question open unless category-specific guidance is explicitly provided.

Large intuitive choices:

- Families & Kids
- High-School Seniors
- Maternity
- Couples & Engagement

Each opens a dedicated page for further session-specific info for families & kids, high school seniors, maternity, etc.

Find Your Setting

Gardens, rustic trails, city streets or somewhere meaningful to you. See what some of my favorite Dayton-area locations actually look like before choosing.

Explore Locations → (link to Locations page) Already have somewhere special in mind? Tell me about it. (Lets client know they can make suggestions)

How It Works

Keep extremely concise:

Choose session → “See Availability and Book” through ShootProof → Complete questionnaire → Planning/communication as needed → Session → Finished gallery within 7–10 business days.

Reviews

Use approximately three prominently and up to five total. These are pulled directly from the Facebook Page reviews.

General FAQ

Expandable accordion turning this general session information into easy collapsible and expandable Q&As.

Short About section

Brief photo + personable introduction.

Footer

Quiet links to:

- social platforms
 - main art/shop website
 - contact options
-

8. Client reviews

Use first name + last initial only.

Do not show review dates from Facebook or last names—use first initial of the last name only.

Initial strongest options include excerpts from:

Curtis H.

Strongest family positioning: reluctant children became relaxed and personalities came through.

Chris L.

Strong validation of making family pictures fun for children.

“Can’t thank you enough for the session today Julie! We had a blast and you’re an expert at getting kids to find the fun in family pictures. Awesome job, thanks again!”

Marianne M. K.

Strong communication, comfort, fun and wanting photographs displayed at home.

"My family had so much fun doing our photoshoot with Julie. She had fun, creative ideas for us to do and props to bring. She kept in contact with us prior to the shoot and after. We felt comfortable and had so much fun. I highly recommend her. The photos turned out amazing. :) I cannot wait to hang them in my home!"

Emily A. C.

Strong Couples/Engagement testimonial and creative collaboration.

"Julie is such a fantastic photographer! She takes your ideas and creates amazing pictures! She is such an outgoing, energetic person and I couldn't have asked for a better engagement photo session. I highly recommend her!"

Brie F.

Strong validation of professionalism, encouragement and coaching. *"I'm a makeup artist who has had the pleasure of working with Julie and she's so professional and kind. I love a photographer that can coach you and give you encouragement through the shots. She's awesome!"*

Also retain Jaime P. and Curtis H. as a useful future testimonial about collaborative shot selection and interaction with kids.

Jamie P. M.

Creative collaboration

"Julie is absolutely amazing! She is so patient and has a good eye! If you are looking for a great photographer, she's the one! I loved that she let us pick some certain shots we wanted as well! Will definitely be using her again."

Curtis H.

Reluctant kids end up relaxing

"Anyone can take a picture Julie captured a moment and made it art. My kids were reluctant to have their pictures taken. Julie made them feel relaxed and let them be themselves and let their personalities shine through on 'film.' I couldn't be happier with the results!"

Reviews can be replaced or added later without redesigning the review system.

Do not build an unnecessarily complex dedicated review-management platform.

9. Locations page

Include:

- *“Great for a fun family half-mile walk as a family adventure to a large pond, scenic trails, fun, rustic steps.”* Lovely colors in the fall, very peaceful, and often zero crowds – **Sycamore State Park**
- *“Great for those who love lots of flowers, arbors, little pockets of hidden places around every corner, plus surprises just for little ones”* Perfect for late spring through late summer sessions – **Wegerzyn Gardens**
- [Placeholder text] [Placeholder text] – **Cox Arboretum**
- [Placeholder text] [Placeholder text] – **Carriage Hill Metro Park**
- [Placeholder text] [Placeholder text] – **Oregon District, Downtown Dayton**
- [Placeholder text] [Placeholder text] – **Germantown Dam**
- ... a way to add several more eventually and allow them to filter based on desired season and other potential ways to filter

Recommend common template form for each one covering parent questions such as: How much walking is involved with each location, if a location has bathroom available or not, parking information, other helpful information to consider

Location name → short “what it feels like” description → 4–8 actual portraits within my portfolio taken there → best suited for → general walking level → restroom availability if known → parking notes if useful → any accessibility considerations → seasonal strengths → button to see availability/book sessions.

Conceptually each location should have:

- Name
- shortDescription
- bestFor
- walkingLevel
- restrooms
- parking
- accessibility
- bestSeasons
- portfolioImages
- video
- See availability and bookingLink
- status

The gallery for each location on this page will be 4-10 still images for user to click on, enlarge and swipe through.

Optional location video: Each location template must support one optional short video, generally under 20–30 seconds, showing the setting itself through several brief clips. The still-image portfolio remains the primary content. Videos must never autoplay. Display a still poster/thumbnail with a subtle tap-to-play control. Do not automatically play audio. Video assets should be lazy-loaded/optimized for mobile so they do not slow the Locations page. If no video has been supplied, display nothing publicly—no empty

player and no “coming soon” placeholder. The video field should remain available internally so one can be added later without redesigning the location template.

10. Families & Kids page

Include:

- dedicated family portfolio
- photography philosophy
- pricing/session guidance
- outfit help
- child preparation
- Pinterest inspiration
- FAQ
- booking CTA

Core message:

Children do not need to perform for the session to succeed.

The photographer adapts to children's personalities and energy.

Toddlers/young children may be photographed:

- walking with parents
- being carried
- playing
- sitting on a quilt
- swinging
- interacting with parents/siblings
- using favorite comfort items
- on shoulders
- moving naturally

Parents should avoid building the photography session into a high-pressure event.

Recommended way to describe it to children:

“We're going to the park and Julie is going to take some pictures while we hang out and play.”

Avoid:

- repeated “Smile!”
- pressure
- threats/rewards before the session
- constant coaching from parents unless necessary for safety/behavior

If a child needs:

- snack
- diaper change
- brief break
- a few minutes to move around

that should not create anxiety.

Although this more candid style leans heavily toward natural interaction, there can be classic everyone-together, smile-at-the-lens portraits when desired, however the entire session is not structured with any type of rigid posing.

Sessions are generally recommended in the morning or later in the day, often within the couple of hours leading up to sunset when outdoor light becomes softer and more flattering. Available dates and times can be viewed through the booking link. Clients should be directed to click a button to see the session availability dates/times and booking information through ShootProof.

The session is also not governed by a ruthless stopwatch. It is an approximation and includes shooting time, not time spent walking from spot to spot or giving kids a short break, if needed, etc.

The family dog pet(s) can be part of the session as long as they bring a helper if they want any family sessions without the pet. Also, the dog must remain leashed and please bring waste bags and treats for them. If the leash is able to be photoshopped out, it will be removed.

My child is autistic, very shy, has sensory needs or needs extra time. Is that okay?

The answer should essentially be:

Absolutely. You don't need to share anything you're uncomfortable sharing, but if there is something that helps your child feel more comfortable or communicate more easily, let me know so I can adapt the session.

And:

Will you post photographs of my children online?

Only with written permission. You're welcome to keep your session private, and children's names and ages are not published.

Also make sure in this page's dedicated FAQ section of collapsible and expandable questions with corresponding answers specific to families & kids should make it clear their portraits and their children's portraits are never publicly posted until they provide explicit permission by signing a release form.

Larger/extended families of **more than seven people should contact the photographer before booking**, although the regular pricing system may still apply.

Blended, divorced, step and unconventional family structures are welcome. Clients should simply communicate who is important to photograph.

11. High-School Seniors page

Speak to **both senior and parent**.

Different audiences want different results:

- seniors may want serious/model-like/personality-driven images
- parents often want timeless portraits for announcements, relatives, graduation décor and displays

Senior experience should feel highly personalized rather than cookie-cutter.

Planning may consider:

- sports
- ROTC
- 4-H
- band
- career/technical interests
- gaming/computers
- art
- awards/medals
- cars/trucks
- horses
- instruments
- uniforms
- hobbies
- personality
- meaningful locations

Clients may bring meaningful items at their discretion.

Senior posing approach:

- show example/inspiration ideas
- senior identifies what feels right
- verbally guide pose

- show selected camera-back previews
- adjust collaboratively
- reassure throughout the session

No physical posing/manipulation.

Clothing:

Brief:

typically one primary outfit.

Standard:

approximately one to two looks where desired.

Extended:

approximately two to four looks and/or multiple nearby locations where practical.

Do not advertise split fall/spring sessions or delayed cap-and-gown sessions at launch.

12. Maternity page

Recommended general timing:

approximately 28–34 weeks is a common sweet spot, but there is no single perfect time.

Explain:

- earlier may mean easier movement and a smaller bump
- later may create a fuller traditional maternity shape
- comfort, individual pregnancy circumstances and desired photographic style matter

Do not present the recommendation as a medical rule.

Possible settings:

- outdoor locations
- nursery/home where appropriate and suitable
- same general location system used for other sessions

Participants are client-led:

- mother alone
- partner
- existing children

- pets when appropriate

Style is client-led:

- flowing dress
- casual clothing
- bare belly
- covered belly
- more traditional or natural

Client supplies clothing.

Available photographer prop:

- announcement letter/message board

Personal items may include:

- baby shoes
- personalized blanket if name is known and/or being announced through one of the images
- ultrasound image
- rattle
- other meaningful items

Pinterest inspiration can help clients identify what feels appealing versus too staged/cheesy for them.

Older children may be incorporated later in the session after dedicated maternity photographs.

Core emotional message:

These photographs document a temporary part of both the mother's life and the child's history. The goal is not perfection but something she will later be glad she preserved.

13. Couples & Engagement page

This category includes:

- engagement sessions
- literal surprise proposals
- engagement announcements
- elopement/marriage announcements
- anniversaries

- seasonal couples portraits
- couples simply wanting professional photographs together

WEDDING PHOTOGRAPHY IS NOT OFFERED.

Make this unmistakable.

Planning is consultation-led.

Possible styles:

- walking
- holding hands
- sitting/cuddling
- laughing
- looking at one another
- leaning/resting together
- picnic setup
- seasonal setups
- rings/hands/details
- pets
- meaningful locations
- Any personal ideas they have or meaningful objects between them

Couples vary greatly in comfort with physical affection. Adapt direction to their relationship rather than forcing stereotypical romantic poses.

For camera-conscious couples, begin with movement and easy interaction before increasingly intentional portraits.

Goal:

capture affection, friendship, chemistry and actual interaction—not merely professional versions of phone selfies.

Surprise proposals are allowed but require additional planning/contact before the session where appropriate.

14. Clothing guidance

Overall philosophy:

Coordinate without making everyone match.

Clients should not feel obligated to purchase an entirely new wardrobe.

Recommended approach:

1. Start with 2–4 pieces already owned and liked.
2. Create a loose complementary palette from those pieces.
3. Mix solids and a limited number of patterns.

Avoid:

- strongly clashing colors
- everyone wearing competing patterns
- prominent logos/text unless intentionally thematic
- neon footwear when it can reasonably be avoided

Patterns are welcome when coordinated.

Example:

one or two patterned outfits combined with complementary solids often photographs better than everyone wearing identical solids.

Fall palettes may include:

- dark green
- brown
- cream
- maroon
- burnt orange
- muted seasonal tones

Spring and Summer palettes may include:

- Blues
- Pinks
- Yellows
- Fun, bright cheerful colors are fine, but nothing distracting

Shoes:

- clean
- reasonably neutral when possible
- don't overthink them; often not very noticeable in portraits

Seniors:

use clothing and accessories that reflect personality.

Possible accents:

hat, scarf, sunglasses, jersey, etc.

Maternity:

solids generally photograph particularly well because they keep attention on mother/belly.

Couples:

coordinate rather than match; avoid competing patterns.

Hair/makeup:

clients should generally look like themselves. Normal routine is perfectly acceptable.

15. Young-child preparation

For babies/toddlers consider bringing:

- favorite toy
- stuffed animal
- meaningful blanket
- snack
- drink/sippy cup
- wipes
- optional backup outfit

Avoid extremely messy/color-staining snacks immediately before or during photographs when possible.

Do not create an intimidating mandatory checklist.

16. Props

Separate mentally and visually into:

Meaningful personal items

Encouraged when relevant.

Examples:

- Grandma's quilt
- favorite stuffed animal

- instrument
- medals
- baby shoes
- special clothing
- meaningful vehicle
- personal sports equipment

Decorative/photography props

Optional, not necessary.

Current photographer inventory includes:

- white/cream quilt
- wooden children's bench
- vintage camera
- maternity message board
- approximately 4-foot battery GRAD marquee letters
- future vintage picnic basket
- future child surprise/reward bags

Client-provided safe/practical furniture or props are acceptable.

17. Prepare for Your Session section

This replaces long PDF guides.

Information should be presented in:

- short summaries
- collapsible accordions
- easily scanned mobile sections
- deeper links only when clients want more detail

Possible sections:

- What should we wear?
- What should we bring?
- Children & family sessions
- Seniors
- Maternity
- Couples
- Weather

- Location/day-of logistics
- Changing outfits
- What happens afterward?
- Gallery downloads/backups
- Questions? Contact Julie

The experience should feel like:

find one answer in 20–30 seconds, not read a guide.

18. Booking and Communication

Booking CTA sends clients to ShootProof.

Clients may contact the photographer before booking if they have questions.

Booking retainer: **\$25 nonrefundable booking retainer**, applied toward the session total.

Remaining balance: due no later than the session date.

Rescheduling: 24+ hours notice generally permits rescheduling/transfer.

Short-notice illness/emergencies may be handled flexibly at photographer discretion.

No-show or cancellation without adequate notice may forfeit the booking retainer.

Weather rescheduling never penalizes the client when initiated based on photographer/weather decision.

Shootproof contract they will need to sign also specifies all of this in detail.

19. Client communication philosophy

ShootProof questionnaire asks for preferred contact method.

Photographer reviews questionnaire and contacts client using preferred method.

Level of planning depends on client needs.

Some need minimal help.

Others may need:

- outfit feedback
- location help
- accommodations for shy/sensory/autistic children
- senior inspiration planning
- maternity concepts
- couples planning

Photographer should proactively check in at least approximately twice between booking and session when appropriate.

Near the session date communicate:

- weather
- location
- exact meeting details
- parking
- any remembered items from client questionnaire

20. Weather policy

Approximately 72 hours before a session: will begin monitoring potential rain and consider possible Plan B.

Approximately 24 hours before: evaluate whether to remain with the original plan, move to Plan B or continue monitoring.

Approximately 12 hours before: reevaluate.

Near session: hourly radar may influence modest timing changes when practical.

Examples:

- delay session slightly
- move slightly earlier
- reschedule if alternative date clearly offers better conditions

Avoid overly complicated public wording.

Client-facing message should communicate:

Weather is monitored closely and decisions are made collaboratively with flexibility rather than automatically cancelling at the first mention of rain.

21. Day-of-session experience

Recommend arriving approximately **5 minutes early when possible**.

If running late:

send a quick message.

Ordinary delays caused by getting children/families ready should be handled reasonably.

Clients should arrive:

- dressed
- hair/makeup ready
- generally prepared to begin

Exact meeting/parking instructions are communicated privately.

Photographer typically arrives 10–15 minutes early and may request vehicle description/color.

Do not publish GPS-coordinate logistics on website.

Initial meeting includes:

- introductions
- brief walk
- conversation
- helping children acclimate
- reviewing inspiration/ideas where relevant
- a few test frames

Session time represents approximate **active photography time**, not an unforgiving stopwatch from the instant the client arrives.

Bathroom availability:

may be limited or nonexistent at outdoor locations.

Clients should plan accordingly.

Extended sessions can include natural breaks between locations/outfit changes.

Photographer owns a pop-up changing tent that may be brought for certain senior/multi-outfit sessions when useful.

22. Session completion / gallery card

Possible future physical thank-you/gallery card is outside the website build.

Potential size: small postcard/4×6-ish cardstock.

Could include:

- thank-you note
- Link given by QR code to their pre-created ShootProof gallery
- ShootProof password information to access their gallery when it is ready
- gallery turnaround expectation
- 30-day expiration reminder

ShootProof/text remains the authoritative digital gallery delivery method.

Do not make the physical card required for launch.

23. Gallery turnaround

Finished gallery delivered through ShootProof within: **7–10 business days**

Gallery should remain available approximately: **30 days**

Clients should be clearly encouraged to:

- download high-resolution files
- avoid relying on screenshots
- retain photographs in at least two storage locations
- ideally maintain one cloud/off-site copy

Long-term archival storage is not guaranteed after gallery expiration.

If a gallery expires, client may contact photographer. Restoration may be possible if files remain available but is not guaranteed.

RAW files are never delivered.

24. Editing philosophy

Standard professional finishing may include, as appropriate:

- exposure
- contrast
- white/black levels
- highlights
- shadows
- color
- cropping
- sharpening
- eye sharpening
- light skin smoothing
- vignette
- distracting background cleanup
- distracting flyaway-hair cleanup
- black-and-white conversion

Photographer may ask questionnaire preference:

- enjoy B&W
- a few are fine
- prefer color only

Not routinely included:

- body/weight reshaping
- major facial alteration
- major physical-feature changes
- difficult object/person reconstruction/removal
- extensive clothing alteration
- complicated tattoo removal

Simple tattoo removal may be attempted by request depending on placement/complexity but is not guaranteed.

25. Culling / artistic discretion

Photographer retains artistic discretion over the final delivered gallery. The website should frame this positively. Final gallery is carefully curated.

Removed photographs may include:

- test frames
- duplicates
- blinks

- missed focus
- awkward transitional expressions
- technical failures

Reassure clients: **good photographs are not intentionally withheld for additional purchase.**

26. Additional edit requests

Clients should report genuine editing concerns within approximately:

7 days after gallery delivery

Photographer will reasonably review genuine issues.

Not included:

- repeated re-editing
- extensive stylistic changes
- unlimited revision requests

Photographer retains discretion to make simple courtesy corrections when reasonable.

27. Client use / print release

Client receives standard personal print/use rights.

Allow:

- personal printing
- albums
- gifts
- sharing with friends/family
- personal social media posting
- reasonable cropping for print ratios/social formats
- ShootProof sharing tools

Do not provide commercial licensing by default.

Clients should be encouraged to use delivered editing as-is.

Reasonable cropping is fine.

If clients significantly:

- recolor
- filter
- substantially re-edit

ask that they not tag/credit The Sunlit Wanderer as photographer for that altered version, to avoid confusion regarding the photographer's editing style.

Do not police minor social-media auto-cropping.

28. Model release / privacy

Model release must be optional rather than a condition of service.

No child names or ages should ever be published with family/kids photographs on:

- website
- social media
- portfolio
- advertising
- marketing

For minors, parent/legal guardian must authorize marketing/model use.

Prefer meaningful release categories rather than one huge blanket checkbox.

Potential client choices:

- Keep my images private.
- Online portfolio/social use permitted.
- Printed promotional use permitted.
- Paid advertising use permitted.
- Ask me before choosing specific images.

Nothing should be pre-checked.

Use ShootProof's photography release/template framework as the starting point for actual legal language rather than inventing legal boilerplate.

Sneak peeks posted publicly count as marketing/public use and require appropriate written permission first.

29. Contact options

Primary: **Messenger**

Use direct business Messenger link once known. (username is @julielewis0322)

Secondary mobile contact:

Google Voice business number: **(513) 318-7278**

For texting, use: **sms :+15133187278**

If calling is also desired, use separately: **tel :+15133187278**

Keep contact controls visible but understated.

Do not use a large intrusive floating Messenger bubble.

Possible placements:

- near hero
- after pricing
- near bottom

30. Pinterest integration

Do not embed large Pinterest feeds at launch.

Session-specific pages may link **directly to relevant Pinterest boards**.

Avoid making users click through an unnecessary Pinterest directory first.

Future inspiration/resource page should be built as an unpublished skeleton.

Potential question-driven navigation:

- What print size works on my wall?
- What are good photo gifts?
- How do I create a gallery wall?
- What are interesting large-format print ideas?
- What album should I make?

- What keepsakes can I create?
- What works with my home style?

Each can jump to an appropriate resource section/board.

31. Future Albums & Keepsakes skeleton

Build but keep:

- out of navigation
- noindex
- excluded from sitemap
- unpublished to ordinary visitors where practical

Future content may include:

- family albums
- senior albums
- layflat options
- leather/linen/vinyl options
- Zno samples
- mini accordion books
- grandparent gifts
- novelty keepsakes
- videos/photos of actual samples

Potential future business model:

DIY: transparent vendor links/recommendations.

Done-for-you: photographer designs/orders for a clearly disclosed design/service fee.

No pricing decision required yet.

32. Future Prop Library skeleton

Build but keep nonpublic/noindex.

Purpose: photographer can selectively send clients a private/reference link during planning.

Should support easy addition/removal of:

- image

- item name
- short description
- category

Clients may then indicate whether they want photographer-provided props or prefer their own meaningful items.

33. Future Specials skeleton

Build reusable architecture but keep hidden at launch.

Future examples:

- Mommy & Me
- Daddy & Me
- seasonal children sets
- holiday/Santa
- Christmas tree farm
- graduation
- other themed minis

Should support:

- title
- date
- description
- images
- price
- appointment length
- ShootProof booking URL
- availability/status
- publish/unpublish

Special-event timing rules may differ from regular sessions.

Stacked minis may require stricter appointment times.

Specials page must be able to turn on/off without disturbing other pages.

34. Future Local Favorites skeleton

Build but keep nonpublic/noindex initially.

Future categories could include legitimate client-relevant local recommendations such as:

- hair/makeup
- salons
- barbers
- clothing boutiques
- florists
- family treats/ice cream
- coffee
- framing/printing
- other useful session-day resources

Do not create a generic reciprocal-link farm.

Businesses should be listed because they provide genuine value to photography clients.

35. Art store integration

Portrait experience should remain focused on photography.

At the bottom/footer only, include a subtle link such as:

Looking for wall art? Visit The Sunlit Wanderer Shop →

Do not interrupt portrait booking flow with product advertising.

36. About section

Keep short, friendly and human.

Possible ingredients:

- photographing off and on since first camera around age eight
- loves family
- dog and cat
- mystery books
- cannot turn down chocolate
- brief line connecting photography to preserving genuine memories

Do not create a lengthy biography.

37. Visual identity

Primary background:

Warm Cream

Core palette:

- Primary Forest #1a2217
- Warm Cream #e6caaa
- Olive #5f502a
- Rust #954c20
- Soil #312615
- Gold #b68b45

Overall feeling:

- earth
- nature
- calm
- relaxed
- friendly
- warm
- outdoors-oriented
- handcrafted
- polished

Use colors as restrained accents.

Dark sections may be used intentionally around galleries to make:

- color photographs
- black-and-white photographs

stand out.

Prioritize generous whitespace/breathing room.

Nothing should feel cramped.

38. Typography / wordmark

Use custom handwritten “**The Sunlit**” artwork when finalized. Current “The Sunlit” wording is personal cursive writing turned into use for the logo, but will be providing a better, thicker version using calligraphy pen soon to update logo and provide what else is needed. Each main section within the site or one specific central header can be this personal handwriting style to be unique.

Do not depend on the handwriting as a complete web font if unnecessary for completion of this, and simply recommend a more unique script which is similar in vibe and tone to use in place of if it makes more sense.

Use it sparingly as a brand wordmark/accent.

Use highly readable standard web typography for:

- body
- navigation
- pricing
- FAQs
- accessibility

Future updated handwritten wordmark may be supplied as:

- SVG
- transparent PNG

Site architecture should make swapping the logo/wordmark straightforward.

39. Logo/header behavior

Homepage may use a fuller logo/wordmark.

Interior pages should use a compact header such as:

sun icon + The Sunlit Wanderer

linked to Home.

Avoid oversized repeated logos.

Footer may include logo again.

Create favicon/app icon using appropriate brand icon where available.

40. Image styling

Prefer:

- clean/square edges
- perhaps subtle frame/border treatment
- restrained rustic character

Avoid literal heavy barnwood frames around every photograph unless later tested and approved.

Potential alternative:

thin soil/gold/cream framing details.

Photography should remain the dominant visual element. If no framing around images looks better for design, disregard any border framing.

41. Buttons

Use clean rectangular or very slightly softened rectangular buttons.

Avoid overly bubbly/app-like pill controls unless functionally appropriate.

CTA hierarchy must be clear without feeling pushy.

42. Navigation

Prioritize simplest possible user experience.

Mobile navigation should remain minimal.

Use hamburger menu if that provides the clearest experience.

Likely core navigation:

- Home
- Sessions
- Prepare
- See Availability and Book

- Questions/contact
- Locations must be easily discoverable from the homepage's Find Your Setting section and from relevant session pages. It may appear inside the Sessions navigation group/dropdown rather than requiring another top-level mobile navigation item if that keeps navigation cleaner.

Category access should remain obvious.

43. Persistent booking control

Mobile only.

Use a visually quiet but thumb-friendly fixed booking action.

Do not make it aggressive.

Where another obvious booking button is already visible, consider hiding/collapsing the fixed version to avoid:

BOOK / BOOK / BOOK clutter.

Do not use a persistent booking bar on desktop unless testing later proves useful.

44. Motion

Keep interface primarily still.

Avoid:

- autoplay slideshows
- parallax overload
- bouncing buttons
- distracting animation

Acceptable:

- subtle accordion animation
 - minimal hover feedback on desktop
 - very restrained transitions where they improve usability
-

45. Accessibility

Accessibility takes priority over decorative aesthetics.

Include:

- sufficient color contrast
- readable font sizes
- proper heading hierarchy
- semantic markup
- keyboard navigation
- visible focus states
- descriptive alt-text system
- accessible gallery controls
- reduced-motion consideration
- sufficient touch-target size
- avoid excessive text embedded inside images

Custom script must never be required to understand important information.

46. Performance

Prioritize fast mobile performance.

Optimize:

- image dimensions
- responsive images
- compression
- lazy-loading where appropriate
- modern formats where appropriate
- minimal unnecessary JavaScript

Do not sacrifice visible photo quality unnecessarily.

47. Analytics/privacy

Launch with:

no analytics/tracking system

Do not install Google Analytics or other visitor tracking unless explicitly requested later.

This reduces complexity/privacy burden.

No site contact form at launch.

Primary contact remains Messenger/text.

48. SEO

Implement sensible foundational SEO:

- unique page titles
- useful meta descriptions
- semantic headings
- descriptive URLs
- image alt text
- canonical URLs where appropriate
- structured sitemap for public pages
- robots directives
- social/OpenGraph sharing metadata
- local-business relevant structured data where appropriate
- fast mobile experience

Do not:

- keyword stuff
- create fake city landing pages
- create thin SEO pages
- use hidden keyword blocks
- create reciprocal-link schemes

Homepage geographic phrasing:

Dayton, Ohio and surrounding communities

49. Public versus unpublished pages

Public at launch:

- Home

- Locations
- Families & Kids
- High-School Seniors
- Maternity
- Couples & Engagement
- Prepare
- relevant FAQ/contact components

Built as skeletons but **not public/indexable initially**:

- Specials
- Ideas/Pinterest Resources
- Albums & Keepsakes
- Local Favorites
- Prop Library

For unpublished pages:

- noindex
- exclude from sitemap
- omit from public navigation
- do not expose as completed content

50. Future extensibility

Architecture must allow future new pages using reusable patterns.

Potential future pages/categories:

- Pets
- Lifestyle Newborns
- Boudoir
- Holiday (Specials page)
- Santa (Specials page)
- Christmas tree farm (Specials page)
- seasonal campaigns (Specials page)
- private woodland sessions (planned add to Locations section, will also likely be part of future Specials page when special sessions are planned for this location)

Boudoir may eventually become a separate subdomain/project rather than part of the main portrait site. It may be locked down with a password printed on business cards handed out to potential interested parties with the portfolio not open to the general public. Still unclear how it

will be structured. Leave it available as a nonindex future page for now but keep separate subdomain/project potential there in case this is the chosen direction for 2027.

51. Content architecture

Do not bury all content inside monolithic component code.

Separate reusable content logically.

Suggested structure conceptually:

content/

- site
- pricing
- reviews
- faq
- locations
- links

galleries/

- home
- families
- seniors
- maternity
- couples

pages/

- Home
- locations
- families
- seniors
- maternity
- couples
- prepare
- specials
- inspiration
- albums
- local-resources
- prop-library

Exact technology may vary based on your recommendation.

52. Centralized configuration

Store external/service links centrally.

Examples:

- ShootProof booking link
- category-specific booking links
- Messenger URL
- Google Voice number
- Instagram
- Facebook
- TikTok
- Shopify/main store
- Pinterest profile
- family Pinterest boards
- senior boards
- maternity boards
- couples boards
- future wall-art boards
- album vendors
- future local-partner links

One link change should update all relevant usages.

53. Content inventory / missing-assets checklist

Maintain a human-readable checklist of missing or placeholder content.

Include items such as:

Images

- final homepage hero
- 12–20 homepage mixed portfolio
- Locations galleries
 - Sycamore portfolio images
 - Wegerzyn portfolio images
 - Cox portfolio images
 - Carriage Hill portfolio images
 - Oregon District portfolio images
 - Germantown Dam portfolio images
 - optional location videos
 - video poster/thumbnail images

- confirmed walking/restroom/parking/accessibility notes
- Families gallery
- Seniors gallery
- Maternity gallery
- Couples gallery
- About photo
- future album/product sample images

Links

- final ShootProof booking URL(s)
- Messenger URL
- Facebook
- Instagram
- TikTok
- Shopify
- Pinterest boards
- future vendor links

Branding

- final logo
- final thicker handwritten wordmark
- sun icon
- favicon

Content

- final About copy
- final reviews/excerpts
- any unresolved FAQ language

Claude should never silently leave forgotten placeholder content.

54. Maintainability

The site is being maintained primarily through AI-assisted development rather than a traditional developer/CMS.

Optimize architecture accordingly.

A future request should be easy to execute, such as:

Replace images 3, 7 and 12 in the Seniors gallery.

Add this FAQ to Maternity.

Change session pricing.

Add this Pinterest link.

Create a new Special using the existing template.

Changes should not require redesigning unrelated components.

55. Change-control rule — critical

Never change anything outside the specifically requested scope unless it is technically unavoidable.

When a requested change could affect another part of the site:

1. explain the dependency
2. propose the necessary additional change
3. do not execute that unrelated change without approval

No unsolicited:

- redesigning
- copy rewriting
- dependency upgrades
- navigation rearrangement
- gallery changes
- styling changes

during routine content edits.

56. Preview-before-publish rule — critical

Editing and publishing must be separate actions.

Required workflow:

request → modify → validate/test → create preview → user reviews → explicit approval → production deployment

Never automatically deploy a requested content change directly to production.

User should be able to review preview on mobile or desktop before approving.

57. Unpublished-page workflow

If asked to edit a hidden page:

- keep noindex
- keep out of sitemap
- keep out of navigation
- produce preview
- await approval

When user wants it launched:

prepare changes necessary to:

- remove noindex
 - add sitemap entry
 - add approved navigation/internal links
 - confirm metadata
 - preview public-ready version
 - await final explicit approval
 - only then deploy
-

58. Version control / rollback

Use proper source version control.

Every production deployment should be recoverable.

Requirements:

- meaningful commits/version history
- easy rollback
- production branch protected from accidental edits where practical
- do not depend on a single Claude conversation/session

- site files remain independently accessible

User should be able to say:

Restore the previous production version.

59. Hosting recommendation

Claude should recommend the **simplest reliable hosting option** based on:

- easy deployment
- automatic HTTPS
- custom subdomain support
- preview deployments
- rollback/version history
- low ongoing cost
- straightforward maintenance
- strong static/site performance

Possible providers may include services such as Vercel, Netlify, Cloudflare Pages or another appropriate modern option.

Do not select solely because it is fashionable.

Explain recommendation in plain English before committing.

60. CMS decision

Do **not** build a full CMS/admin dashboard initially.

Use well-structured content/data files that Claude can safely modify.

Architecture should permit migration to a CMS later if maintenance volume eventually justifies one.

61. Documentation

Generate a concise:

HOW_TO_UPDATE_SITE.md

Explain in nondeveloper language:

- where content lives
- where galleries live
- where external links live
- where pricing lives
- where FAQs live
- how unpublished pages work
- how previews work
- how approval/publishing works
- how rollback works
- what not to edit manually
- how to replace images
- how to add new session categories/specials

Also maintain the separate missing-assets/content checklist.

62. Build approach

Before writing substantial production code:

1. Review these requirements.
2. Identify contradictions or technical risks.
3. Recommend an architecture and hosting approach.
4. Explain it in plain language suitable for a nondeveloper.
5. Identify decisions that genuinely must be made before coding.
6. Avoid asking questions whose answers already exist in this requirements document.
7. Build the site incrementally.
8. Use placeholders when assets/links are not yet available.
9. Clearly track every placeholder.
10. Do not publish anything publicly until specifically authorized.